

THE GRASP

All the time in the world.

FEATURE FILM | FOLK HORROR / PSYCHOLOGICAL DRAMA | 101 PAGES

Written by Cory Armer

LOGLINE

When a burned-out couple escapes to an Arctic island where the sun never sets, she surrenders to a warm, timeless community that gently lets its members disappear, while he clings to counting the days, until he learns the island has always needed someone to keep count.

THE STORY

Lena and Jonas are drowning in alarms, deadlines, and overdue bills. When an article about Sommarøy, a Norwegian island "where time doesn't exist," appears on Jonas's laptop, they quit everything and take the 7:40 ferry out of Tromsø.

The island welcomes them with a festival that seems to last for days under the midnight sun. Then the music stops, and Jonas realizes nineteen days have vanished. Every villager, they discover, was once an exhausted outsider like them. Lena surrenders to the island's rhythm and befriends Kari, a young woman who is slowly forgetting her own name. Jonas starts counting, until another hand begins writing in his notebook.

When Kari lies down in a chalk spiral and the village sings her to rest, Jonas learns the island's one rule: the ferry only comes when somebody goes. He plans their escape. Lena chooses to stay, and asks him to walk her into a spiral of her own. In the silence afterward, where no one is ever supposed to say the name again, Jonas says hers, and becomes the one person on the island who must remember every name.

THE ISLAND'S RULE

The ferry only comes when somebody goes. It always takes four days.

WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

A horror film about burnout: the dream of escaping the clock, and what it would really cost. The island never locks a door. Its horror is kindness, and its ending is a succession rather than an escape.

COMPARABLES

The Wicker Man meets **Midsommar**, with the grief and ambiguity of **The Leftovers**.

Contained cast, one island location, and no night shoots.